

Canadian History





About the Course

Read about Canadian history from 1800-1900 through biographies, primary source documents, history spines, and historical fiction. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 11-12 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for Grade 11 and Grade 12.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11-12	Canadian History: Grades 11-12 1 time/week 40 min 1 time/week 30 min	A History of Canada in Ten Maps: Epic Stories of Charting a Mysterious Land Early Voices How Different It Was: Canadians at the Time of Confederation The Unweaving Making of Canada: An Epic History in Twenty Extraordinary Lives

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 11-12 (Canada)				
Canadian History: Grades 11-12	Canadian History: Grades 11-12	Ancient History: Grades 10-12	World History: Grades 10-12	Ancient History: Grades 10-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian History: Grades 11-12



A History of Canada in Ten Maps: Epic Stories of Charting a Mysterious Land



Early Voices



How Different It Was: Canadians at the Time of Confederation



The Unweaving



Making of Canada: An Epic History in Twenty Extraordinary Lives



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Not One Way to Mark a Book](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Canadian History: Grades 11-12

How To Approach



Recap

- Take a second to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Read

- Read the selection assigned OR read for the number of minutes allocated, leaving time for narration and mapwork. Use whichever guide (i.e., pages or minutes) works best for you. You want to read enough to be interesting, but not so much that you feel overwhelmed.
- If a book is challenging for you as a student, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently for a minute every now and then to make sure you are tracking. You might also want to read aloud to yourself. Or you might want to listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along with it.
- If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride!
- Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

- Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate.
- To keep yourself on track, you might want to set a timer, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

- After your narration, think about how what you read connects to other subjects, other books, and other things you've read, watched, or seen in the past or present.
- Share any ideas that are particularly interesting to you with your fellow classmates, teachers, parents, friends, or others. You might even want to do a bit more reading or research on something on your own time in the afternoon or evenings.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to the student, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

Those educating at home might pick one or two history lessons to read aloud with their students to keep up the habit of oral narration and foster conversation and relationship, and then simply give students these lesson plans and the rest of the books and check in with them throughout the term for conversation, support, and accountability.

It is valuable for those in a classroom setting to also have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrated together. Classroom settings lend

themselves well to additional discussion and sharing at the end of lessons, after everyone has narrated either together or independently in writing.

SAMPLE

Canadian History: Grades 11-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction, David Thompson

 Materials: A History of Canada in Ten Maps

✕ **GATHER SUPPLIES:** You will need a notebook for Canadian history where you will be writing and drawing. We recommend dot grid and blank notebooks, but any kind will do.

PREP: Print a copy of the blank map of Canada without borders. You can use this together with your notebook to mark places and chart routes throughout this course.

∞ Map Link: Printable Map of Canada without Borders

→ INTRO

In this course, we will learn about the history of Canada between 1800-1900. The five books are intended to work together to give a chronological overview of this historical period. Two of the books - The History of Canada in Ten Maps and The Making of Canada - we are starting partway through, since the first halves were read during Rotation 2. If you did not read them during Rotation 2, you may wish to read the first halves on your own time; however, you can also start partway through without missing content for this course.

At the beginning of this century, Canada was a collection of separate British colonies and was vulnerable to invasion by the newly independent nation of the United States to the south. Yet by the end of the century, Canada was a self-governing country of seven provinces and two territories, with a transcontinental railway that stretched from coast to coast. This class will explore many of the changes that took place during this time.

→ DISCUSS

What do you remember about Canadian History before 1800? What do you already know about the period between 1800-1900? Jot down a few notes for yourself of any people, places, or events that you think might be relevant. Also, write down any questions you might have about this period of Canadian history.

→ READ

1. The Canadian Encyclopedia

As you work through the course, you should find time to fill out a History Chart for the years 1800-1900, or continue to update your Book of Centuries if you have one. The Canadian Encyclopedia is an excellent source for research and information to add to your notebooking.

∞ Article Link: David Thompson Biography

2. The History of Canada in Ten Maps

p.227-236 "In the dead of winter" - "until the twentieth century."

→ NARRATE

Narrate in a way that helps you interact with the ideas in the reading. For some, that might be narrating orally or silently to yourself, in writing, by drawing a map, a diagram or a picture, writing a diary/letter from the point of view of one of the characters, describing what happened, or writing a bulleted list of points and questions. For others, it might be helpful to make marks in the book as you read and then narrate as you look at what you marked in the chapter. Experiment and see what works well for you, and you can vary your approach week to week. Also, strive to make connections to ideas, events, and people you have come across in previous readings you have done.

→ DISCUSS

• EXTRA HELPING

If you would like to watch a linear, narrative recounting of the historical events of 1800-1900 to supplement your studies this term, look for episodes of CBC's Canada: A People's History (2000-2001) at your local library or online. The following episodes cover the period of our history rotation this year:

Episode 5: A Question of Loyalties (1775-1815)

Episode 6: The Pathfinders (1670-1850)

Episode 7: Rebellion and Reform (1815-1850)

Episode 8: The Great Enterprise (1850-1867)

Episode 9: From Sea to Sea (1867-1873)

Episode 10: Taking the West (1873-1896)

∞ **Video Link:** Canada: A People's History



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Most lessons will include optional questions for further discussion, written response, or reflection.

- What made David Thompson such a successful cartographer and explorer? How much was his own skill, and how much was it his willingness to heed and learn from indigenous assistance, knowledge, and practices?
- Why was David Thompson's work so important for fur trading companies and the government?

WEEK 1 □ 30m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

David Thompson, cont.

□ Materials: A History of Canada in Ten Maps

→ ANNOTATE

As your ability to read higher-level books in high school grows, it is helpful to learn new ways to interact with the text while you are reading to help you grasp what the author is saying. Non-fiction books are usually good candidates for annotating while you read. Maybe you want to underline the main ideas or interesting points. Maybe you want to put a question mark in the margin if something is unclear. Think about how to help yourself engage with the information in the book to make it your own. Experiment with different ways to do that. Some students do best by recording themselves talking about the reading, while others may need to discuss the material with another person. Whatever you do, your annotations should help you to further solidify the main points or ideas in your mind. Write down any questions, comments, or connections that arise from your review of your annotations after reading. Try different ways and discuss your observations about what works well and what doesn't with your teacher.

Explore ways that might be most helpful for you as you read each week. Advances in technology make many more annotation options available to serve us and our various ways of processing. Some might do great with a pencil and a book, while others might benefit from colors, Post-its, or speech-to-text options.

Linked are two documents to give you some more ideas for what it means to annotate a text. Charlotte Mason talked about ways to use books in *School Education* on p.180-181 if you are interested in reading her words on the topic, too.

Today's reading and the next are shorter to allow you time to read the documents and practice annotating. For today, if you are new to this, start simply by putting a mark in the margin or a Post-it flag when you come across a main idea or an important point the author is making. For others who have been doing this already, see what new ways you might want to experiment with this term.

∞ Article Link: [How to Mark a Book](#)

∞ PDF Link: [Not One Way to Mark a Book](#)

∞ Book Link: *School Education* p.180

→ RECAP

Where did you leave David Thompson from your reading last time?

→ READ

p.236-245 "As Thompson and his companions" - "cartographer virtually without equal."

→ MAP VIEW

∞ Map Link: [David Thompson Map of the Northwest \(1814\)](#)

→ DISCUSS

- Why do you think Shoalts titled the chapter "David Thompson's Demons"? How did fear and superstition influence exploration in the



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Canadian West? Did these stories serve a purpose beyond instilling fear?

- What does today's reading reveal about Thompson's character? How was he able to accomplish what he did?

WEEK 2 40m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

The War of 1812: Charles de Salaberry

Materials: The Making of Canada

→ INTRO

The Making of Canada is a collection of biographical vignettes that will introduce you to largely forgotten historical figures who were nevertheless vital to significant events in Canada's history. You will read this book alongside A History of Canada in Ten Maps to build a chronological view of this historical period.

→ READ & ANNOTATE

p.148-158 "Almost thirty years after" - "what they achieved at Châteauguay."

→ NARRATE

Choose the best way for you to narrate what you read.

→ DISCUSS

- The War of 1812 is usually synonymous with the battles near Upper Canada that occurred in 1812, especially the Battle of Queenston Heights, where Sir Isaac Brock was killed. Why was Lower Canada a more strategically critical region to protect, according to Koabel? And why might French Canadians have been hesitant at first to help defend it? What changed?
- Why was the Battle at Châteauguay a distinctly Canadian episode of the War of 1812? What are some of the possible reasons why it is not commemorated by English-speaking or French-speaking Canadians today?

★ TEACHER NOTE

To learn more about the War of 1812 (which lasted until 1815), visit this virtual exhibit at the Canadian War Museum to learn about the war from four different perspectives.

∞ Link: 1812 Virtual Exhibition

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

The War of 1812: The Siege of Fort Erie

Materials: The History of Canada in Ten Maps

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the causes of the War of 1812 from the last reading?

→ READ & ANNOTATE

p.246-260 "Explorers might make" - "this present business."

→ NARRATE

Choose the best way for you to narrate what you read.

→ MAP WORK

Cross-reference the battles mentioned in today's reading with a map of the major events in the Niagara region during the War of 1812.

∞ Map Link: The War of 1812 Major Canada/US Theatres

→ DISCUSS

- How does Drummond's leadership compare with Salaberry's from the last reading?
- Why was Fort Erie a strategically important location?
- How were the Canadians particularly skilled at this type of warfare?



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WEEK 3 40m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

The War of 1812: The Siege of Fort Erie, cont.

Materials: The History of Canada in Ten Maps

→ RECAP

What do you recall about General Gordon Drummond's preparations to attack Fort Erie from the last reading? What do you recall about his relative, Lieutenant Colonel William Drummond?

→ READ & ANNOTATE

p.260-272 "As the sun sank" - "forged at a terrible cost."

→ MAP WORK

Continue to consult this map as a reference if needed.

∞ Map Link: The War of 1812 Major Canada/US Theatres

→ NARRATE

Choose the best way for you to narrate what you read.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Soldier Profile: Lieutenant Colonel William Drummond 104th Foot Regiment

- This is an earlier map by Romilly that was included in a letter to General Drummond, several months after the Siege, in November 1814.

∞ Map Link: Fort Erie as left by the Enemy

→ DISCUSS

- Why didn't the British army's failure on August 15th result in the Americans gaining access to Upper Canada? What held them back?
- What do you think might have happened had Napoleon not been defeated or the American capital not been captured?
- Why did the British not insist that the American territory under its control (including parts of Maine) was to be added to British North America?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

The Red River Colony and the Pemmican Wars: Cuthbert Grant

Materials: The Making of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the end of the War of 1812?

→ READ & ANNOTATE

p.159-168 "As American and British diplomats gathered" - "Red River Colony as a threat."

→ MAP WORK

View a map of the land that was granted to Lord Selkirk.

∞ Map Link: Selkirk's Land Grant

→ NARRATE

Choose the best way for you to narrate what you read.

→ VIEW

Learn more about the origins of the Red River Colony (also called the Selkirk Settlement).

∞ Video Link: The Selkirk Settlers; Thomas Douglas, 5th Earl of Selkirk

→ DISCUSS



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- Describe the various groups associated with the Red River settlement. Which ones are allies? Where do you anticipate there will be conflict between them?

SAMPLE